

Suspicious IP The IP address 185.45.23.11 is clearly suspicious. It was responsible for all three failed login attempts and the final successful login on the admin account within just 53 seconds.

Attack Type This is a Brute Force Attack. The attacker used an automated tool to rapidly try different passwords for the admin account in very quick succession. No human can manually attempt three logins within 13 seconds.

Was the Attack Successful? Yes the attack was fully successful. After three failed attempts at 10:10:12, 10:10:18, and 10:10:25 the attacker successfully logged into the admin account at 10:11:05. This is the worst possible outcome because admin accounts have the highest level of access on a system.

Severity Critical. This is the highest possible severity level because an admin account was compromised. The attacker now has full control over the system and can create accounts, delete data, install malware, and cause severe damage.

Suggested Response Immediately lock the admin account, block IP 185.45.23.11 on the firewall, investigate all actions performed after the successful login, reset admin credentials, and enable two factor authentication.

OFFICIAL INCIDENT REPORT

Title: Brute Force Attack — Successful Admin Account Compromise

Time: April 10, 10:10:12 to 10:11:05

User: admin

IP: 185.45.23.11

Description:

On April 10th at 10:10:12 AM the SIEM system detected multiple rapid failed login attempts targeting the admin account from the external IP address 185.45.23.11. A total of three failed login attempts were recorded within 13 seconds between 10:10:12 and 10:10:25. At 10:11:05 a successful login was recorded from the same IP address, indicating that the attacker successfully guessed or cracked the admin password using a brute force tool.

The time gap between each failed attempt confirms this was an automated attack and not a manual login attempt by a human user. The attacker gained full administrative access to the

system which poses an extreme risk to the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of all data and systems under that admin account.

Severity: CRITICAL

Actions Taken:

L1 Analyst Action: The L1 analyst received the SIEM alert at 10:11:10, reviewed the log entries, confirmed the brute force pattern, and immediately escalated the incident to the L2 analyst marking it as critical severity.

L2 Analyst Action: The L2 analyst investigated the logs in detail and confirmed the successful admin account compromise. They took the following immediate containment actions. First they locked the admin account to terminate the active session and prevent further access. Second they blocked the IP address 185.45.23.11 on the firewall to stop any further connection attempts. Third they pulled all post-login activity logs to determine exactly what the attacker did after gaining access including what files were accessed, what commands were run, and whether any new accounts were created. Fourth they preserved all log evidence for the incident report.

L3 Expert Action: The L3 expert reviewed the full investigation report from L2 and took the following long term actions. First they performed a full system audit to check if the attacker installed any backdoors, malware, or created any hidden accounts during the session. Second they reset the admin account password with a strong complex password and enforced two factor authentication on all admin accounts. Third they created a new SIEM detection rule to automatically block any IP that fails to login more than three times within 60 seconds. Fourth they conducted a threat intelligence lookup on IP 185.45.23.11 using AbuseIPDB and VirusTotal and confirmed it was a known malicious IP previously reported for brute force attacks by multiple organizations. Fifth they submitted a full incident report to management with recommendations.

Status: RESOLVED — Admin account secured, attacker IP blocked, system audit completed, two factor authentication enforced.

Evaluation

Correct Analysis: The attack was correctly identified as a brute force attack based on the pattern of three rapid failed logins within 13 seconds followed by a successful login from the same IP. The suspicious IP 185.45.23.11 was identified immediately and confirmed as malicious through threat intelligence tools.

Clear Report: The incident has been documented clearly with exact timestamps, the affected user account, the source IP, a full description of the attack timeline, severity classification, and all actions taken by L1, L2, and L3 analysts in a structured format.

Proper Response: The response followed the correct incident response procedure. Immediate containment was performed by locking the account and blocking the IP. A full investigation was conducted to assess damage. Long term prevention measures including two factor authentication and new SIEM detection rules were implemented to prevent the same attack from succeeding again in the future.